

Unit 2 | Chapter 4: The Why (UI/UX Design)

Learning Targets:	
❖ I can differentiate between UI (Visual Interface) and UX (Architecture/Feel) and apply User-Centered Design (UCD) principles. ❖ I can utilize Visual Hierarchy (Size, Color) and scanning patterns (F-Pattern/Z-Pattern) to guide the user's eye. ❖ I can apply color psychology (Red for urgency, Blue for trust) and the 60-30-10 rule to create balanced palettes. ❖ I can implement Gestalt Principles (Proximity, Similarity) and Affordances to make interfaces intuitive. ❖ I can reduce "Cognitive Load" and "Friction" through consistent navigation, effective microcopy, and system feedback.	
Compelling Question:	
How does a designer use psychology and visual logic to make technology "invisible" and guide users toward their goals without them having to think?	
Score	Performance Indicators
4.0	I can: ☐ Analyze a high-friction user interface and propose a redesign that uses Progressive Disclosure to reduce Cognitive Load. (WEB.3.2.3) ☐ Conduct and interpret an A/B Test to determine which visual layout or Call to Action (CTA) results in higher user conversion. (WEB.1.2.5) ☐ Evaluate a complex design for Dark Patterns and propose ethical alternatives that prioritize the user's best interest. (WEB.3.2.4) ☐ Justify a brand's color palette and typography (Tracking/Leading) using specific psychological theories and accessibility data. (WEB.4.1.3)
3.5	In addition to score 3.0 performance, partial success at score 4.0 content.
3.0	I can: ☐ Apply the 60-30-10 Rule and Accessibility Contrast Ratios to create a balanced, legible UI. (WEB.4.1.2) ☐ Implement Visual Hierarchy using size and color to ensure the Primary Action is the first thing a user sees. (WEB.4.2.3) ☐ Utilize Gestalt Principles (Proximity/Similarity) to group related content and reduce user confusion. (WEB.3.2.1) ☐ Create effective Microcopy and System Feedback (loading states/success messages) to guide users through a task. (WEB.3.2.2) 

	☐ Design "Above the Fold" layouts that prioritize core messages and intuitive Affordances. (WEB.4.2.1)
2.5	No major errors or omissions regarding score 2.0 content, and partial success at score 3.0 content.
2.0	I can ☐ Define common terminology and identify syntax: (WEB.4.2.1) ☐ UI vs. UX, User-Centered Design (UCD), White Space, F-Pattern vs. Z-Pattern, Color Psychology, 60-30-10 Rule, Affordance, Cognitive Load, Friction, CTA, Sans-Serif, Tracking, Leading, The Fold, and Microcopy.
1.5	Partial success at score 2.0 content, and major errors or omissions at 3.0.
1.0	With help, partial success at score 2.0 and score 3.0 content.
0.5	With help, partial success at score 2.0 but not at score 3.0 content.
0.0	Even with help, no success or attempt made.